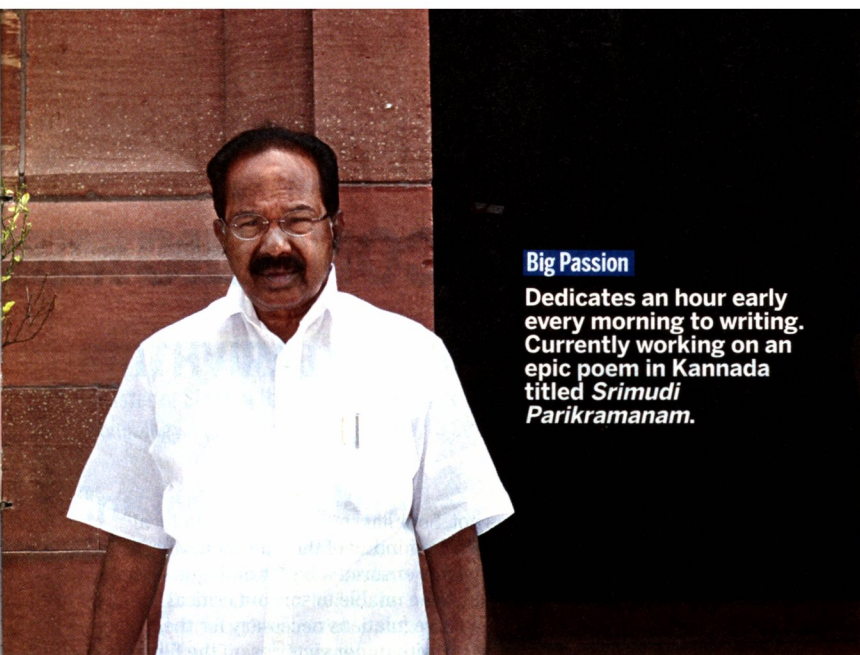




Big Passion

Dedicates an hour early every morning to writing. Currently working on an epic poem in Kannada titled *Srimudi Parikramanam*.

VEERAPPA MOILY

Minister of Law & Justice

Your Honour

Strangely for one who is among the most powerful ministers at the Centre, it is only his first stint in Parliament. A veteran in Karnataka politics and a top lawyer, Moily has suggested key judicial and electoral reforms but has not shown enough muscle to implement them.

Achievements

■ Initiated a programme for developing world-class infrastructure for legal education.

■ Has set in motion a plan to decongest Indian jails by reducing the number of undertrials by two-thirds by July.

Failures

■ Failed to push the Judicial Standards and Accountability Bill for punishing erring members of the judiciary.

■ Missed announcing the National Litigation Policy on its December 31 deadline.

▼ 59%



Achievements

■ Instrumental in repairing ties with China after a chill had set in. The two sides have agreed to move ahead on trade keeping aside the border dispute.

■ Used his personal equation with US Secretary of State Hillary Clinton to push for access to Mumbai 26/11 accused David Headley.

Failures

■ On major foreign policy initiatives, especially on dialogue with Pakistan, he couldn't assert the MEA line that dialogue be linked to progress on terror issues.

■ Failed to push through a proposal to create an India Aid Agency. Buckled under pressure when MEA's choice for India's High Commissioner to South Africa was nixed.

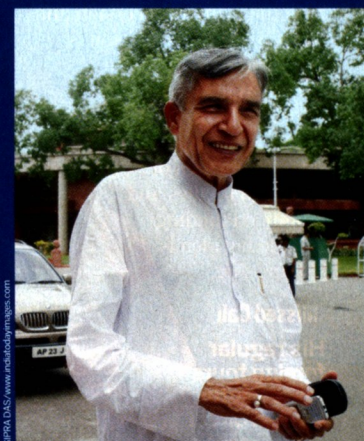
▼ 45%

PAWAN K. BANSAL

Minister of Parliamentary Affairs

Poor Network

The Congress MP from Chandigarh holds the Parliamentary Affairs and Water Resources portfolios but has done miserably in both. Seems a misfit when it comes to floor management in Parliament, forcing veterans Pranab Mukherjee and P. Chidambaram, to act as saviours.



Achievements

■ Is candid about seeking the views of the Opposition.

■ Asserted himself and agreed for a Parliamentary debate on the role of the CBI despite the Government's reluctance.

Failures

■ Despite holding a crucial portfolio, is often clueless about government strategy on key legislation.

■ Has failed to build a network of friends in the Opposition, especially in the Upper House.

Family First

While most politicians are seen at high profile social events, Bansal's evenings are exclusively reserved for his family.

▼ 32%